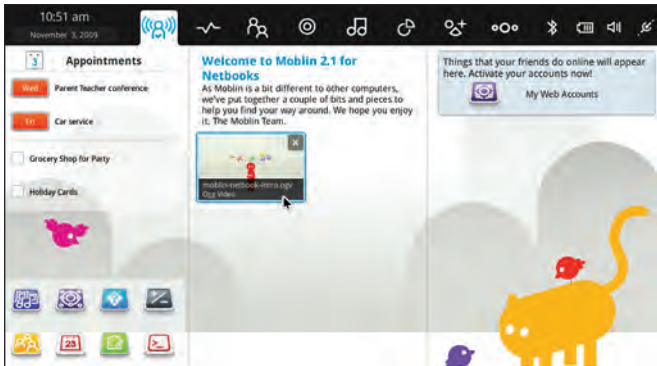


Moblin



www.moblin.com

Unlike most of the other distributions, Intel is the one that backed the Moblin project. After all, it was Intel's Atom that drove the netbook phenomenon. While a lot of people were excited about Moblin at first because it was one of the first of its kind, it's no longer the case anymore. Many more alternatives are available.

Still, Moblin puts up a very good fight. For those who haven't seen it yet, it's clearly one of the most unique looking operating systems and it has no resemblance to Linux whatsoever. Installation to a flash drive is simple and once you boot into the OS, it's all very quick.

A simple panel at the top

ensure you have all the width of the screen to use. The panel gives you access to the applications, settings and connectivity options. It autohides, letting you use the entire screen as much as possible. Netbook users know all too well that there isn't a lot of it.

It's also good to see support for most netbooks – for example, all the shortcuts the EeePC 1000H worked and also the multitouch functionality! Once online, installation of applications also is simple – simply press the Install button next to the application you want. With your Twitter and last.fm accounts setup right, your dashboard shows updates from all your friends – it's a very nice experience.

gOS



www.thinkgos.com

gOS by itself looks like any other Linux distribution. The one difference is the dock below – similar to the one found on OS X. All of the applications are put into shelves within this panel. There are fewer desktop applications and a lot of emphasis is on web based content. A community developed applica-

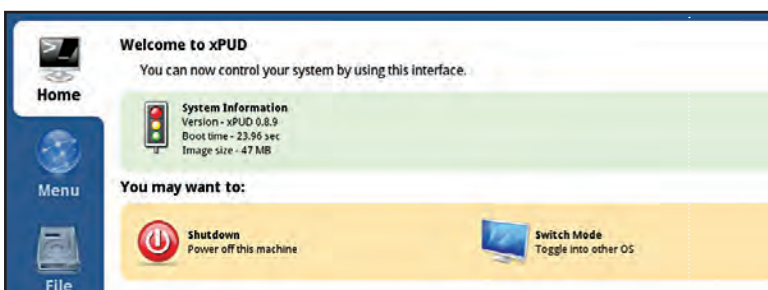
tion called Netbook Launcher allows users to transform the gOS interface into the similar layout found on Ubuntu Netbook Remix. gOS is more of a cloud-computing OS than the rest. For those with speedy connections, it's not a hurdle. For those with limited bandwidth, surely, the rest of the distributions are worth looking at.

Conclusion

When you keep everything in mind, there is no doubt that Jolicloud and Moblin are some of the best netbook operating systems around. Ubuntu Netbook Remix feels like Ubuntu in Jolicloud clothes and it's the same story with Easy Peasy as well. If performance and simplicity is what you want, Xpud is the netbook OS to use. Honestly though, they're all good fun to use and I recommend everyone with a netbook to give them all a try. All you need is a flash drive and the disc ISOs. Look up this month and some of our previous DVDs to find them.



Xpud



www.xpud.org

Xpud, a 64MB distro is the featherweight champion for netbooks or even desktops

for that matter. The distro loads quickly into a simple four menu interface. The menus are basic but the size

and space used up is unnecessary.

The settings menu contains the very basic configuration programs. Data can also be backed up and recovered from it. It's kept very minimal and you could possibly have problem with drivers on unusual hardware. The main menu is for programs and it too has very

few programs that come pre-installed owing to its low download size. Multitasking between applications is a little difficult as well.

The number of downloadable applications isn't very impressive either. This is then a very minimalist OS for those who are looking to browse, chat and maybe watch a few videos on YouTube every now and then. It isn't as slick as say Jodicloud. **d**